

Member Bulletin

August 2026



Welcome to our August update - Tram Trains for Edinburgh continues to grow, extend our influence with city residents, and with the transport sector. Funding a feasibility study is now on the political agenda and provides us a great opportunity to argue for the scheme.

Date for your diary: TTfE Member meeting 7th Sept., see item 5 below

Contents

1. External News
2. Public meetings / media coverage
3. Website and social media
4. Meeting the politicians
5. Next member meeting
6. Chair's comment – why are we doing this?

1. External news & developments

Members will be aware that the SNP included a manifesto commitment for the Scottish Government to fund a feasibility study on the South Sub. This was followed up by a motion at the City Council – the motion or its amended format (asking for a more specific commitment over the next 6 months) were supported by all 5 political groups on the council.

We understand that subsequently the CEC Transport Convenor, Stephen Jenkinson, has written to the Transport Sec., but we don't have any details.

Funding a feasibility study into the South Sub, separate to the SEStransit project, may lead to a less detailed approach (which risks ignoring the regional impact of the scheme) and therefore we are keen to understand if it will be rolled into the wider SEStransit study.

Finally, the City Council has called for 'ideas' and comments for inclusion in the City Plan 2040. We will be emailing members with some suggested feedback to send in.

2. Public meetings / media coverage

Members will recall our intention to hold a public meeting in Gorgie/Dalry on 22nd June. Due to problems with the venue, St Brides Community Centre, this has had to be moved to Tuesday, 1st Sept. – 19.15 for 19.30 start. The meeting will explain the proposal in general, as we haven't done a meeting in that area so far. If you are interested to attend, please use the Eventbrite link to sign up:

[Tram Trains for Edinburgh - St Brides, Gorgie Tickets, Tuesday, September 1 • 7:30 PM - 9 PM | Eventbrite](#)

We will follow a similar format at a public meeting expected to be held in Niddrie/Craigmillar in mid-October. Date/venue to be advised in the near future.

We plan to hold a further meeting on the south side (possibly Eric Liddell centre, Bruntsfield) in December, which will be more of an update on the campaign.

3. Website and social media

Members will have consulted our website www.tffe.org.uk. We plan to put items on the 'news' section regularly from now on. You will notice 'proforma' email templates to send to your councillors, MSPs and MPs. Please use these to send to your representatives – it only takes a minute and some of the MSPs are new and therefore probably unaware of our campaign.

FAQ and 'history' sections are coming soon - and please let us have comments on what could be improved.

We also plan to do more on social media in the future, but for moment the 'reopen the South Sub' Facebook page provides a useful forum with c.1000 viewers. Please add your own comments to this to keep it 'live'.

3. Meeting the politicians

We continue to try to meet with politicians across all Parties to explain and 'sell' the project. We have generally had a very positive response but in some cases, there has been considerable ignorance of the route. Follow-up meetings will be necessary with most.

We have recently had very positive meetings with Cllr. Ben Parker (Green) and Miles Briggs (Conservatives) and correspondence with SNP councillors.

At a meeting with Scott Arthur MP (Labour), he offered to write to the Cabinet Secretary for Transport, Stephen Flynn, asking about the feasibility study, its terms of reference and how it fits with the SEStranist work.

Individual endorsements from politicians are important but getting the project recognised as 'party policy' is the primary objective. Over the coming months the political parties will be writing their manifestos for the City Council elections next year – this is therefore a key moment to write to their representatives, but we will discuss this at the member meeting.

Finally, there are Council byelections in the Southside/Newington and Portobello/Craigmillar wards on Sept. 2nd – we will be writing to candidates requesting they explicitly support better transport for their ward – in the shape of the 'South Sub'!

4. Our next Member meeting 7/9/26 @19.00

Date for your diary – the venue is Paterson's Land as for the AGM - please sign up using the Eventbrite link below:

<https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/tram-trains-for-edinburgh-member-meeting-tickets-1995718948097>

Likely agenda:

1. Possible external speaker from the Consulting world.
2. Update on meetings with sector professionals, opinion formers, politicians, etc.
3. Report back from our internal working groups on different parts of the scheme.
4. Member Q&A

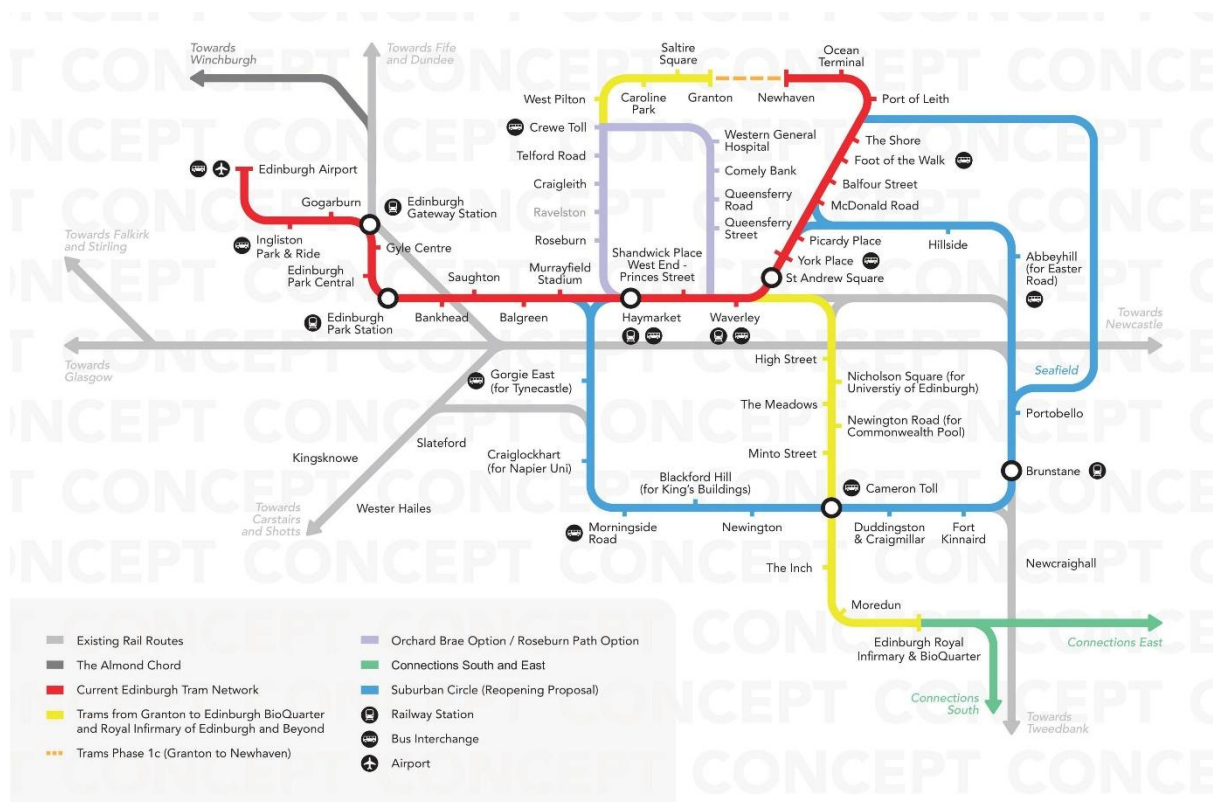


7. Chair's comment – why are we doing this?

Members will be well aware that reopening the South Sub is a long-term objective – see the City Council's 'Metro Map' below. However, focussing on persuading the Scottish Government to fund the study for the business case (cost perhaps £3-5m) is a realistic short-term objective. We are confident that such a case would be very positive, thereby putting pressure on the transport hierarchy to approve the construction of the actual infrastructure.

.....and we shouldn't forget that the real objective is to improve people's journey options across the south side of the city and out into the Lothian region, especially for those whose access to cars is limited, being an important initiative to counter the transport inequality that exists across the city. Of course it will have multiple positive side effects, in terms of reduced congestion & pollution, increased opportunities for active travel and better public transport integration.

See you on 7th September !



The Edinburgh 'Metro Map' - CEC Jan.26

tramtrainsedi@gmail.com

v.2 1/8/26